Document Description Form

As of Oct 7, 2026

Fill in one copy of this form for each document (one letter, one program, one paper) and place it in front of the photographs as a cover page. Type your answers in the "Your entry" column. The last column shows where the information goes in the TEI header; you can ignore it.

How to fill in this form

- **Everyone fills in part A.** Then fill in only the one part (B, C or D) that matches the document type.
- **Required fields are in bold.** Fill as many others as time allows but make sure those are complete
- **Empty is fine.** Leave a field blank if it does not apply or you do not know.
- **Dates:** write YYYY-MM-DD, YYYY-MM or YYYY. For a range write 1962-03/1962-05.
- **Inferred information:** put anything that is not written on the document itself in [square brackets]. Add a question mark if you are unsure, for example [1962-03?].
- **Persons:** write Surname, Forename. Add a GND, VIAF or Wikidata ID if you know it.
- **Titles:** copy titles exactly as they appear, including spelling mistakes.

A. All documents

In the TEI column, `msDesc/` is short for `fileDesc/sourceDesc/msDesc/`. All paths start inside `teiHeader`.

A1. Identification

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Document ID	Your own running number, e.g. NL-Meyer-0042	EXAMPLE-1906-001	`fileDesc/publicationStmt/idno`
Document type	One of: letter, postcard, telegram, conference program, manuscript of paper or talk, printed paper or offprint, notes, other (say what)	letter	`profileDesc/textClass/catRef/@target`
Title of document	Only if the document has one; copy it exactly, leave empty if no title		`fileDesc/titleStmt/title`
Descriptive title	Only if there is no title; e.g. "Letter from A to B, 12 March 1962"	Letter from Ernst Schlote to Maria Lüdeke, Lifang (Tsingtao), 10 June 1906	`fileDesc/titleStmt/title[@type="supplied"]`
Author(s)	Person(s) who wrote or created the document, or “Unknown”	Schlote, Ernst	`fileDesc/titleStmt/author` and `msDesc/msContents/msItem/author`

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Corporate author	Institution, society or committee, if the author is not a person		`fileDesc/titleStmt/author/orgName`

A2. Where the original is kept

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Country	Country of the holding institution	Germany	`msDesc/msIdentifier/country`
City	City of the holding institution	Hannover	`msDesc/msIdentifier/settlement`
Holding institution	Archive, library or private owner	private collection	`msDesc/msIdentifier/repository`
Estate or collection	Name as used by the holder, e.g. "Nachlass Meyer"	Scans: Wikimedia Commons, Category:Ernst Schlote	`msDesc/msIdentifier/collection`
Shelfmark	Box, folder and item number, as used by the holder		`msDesc/msIdentifier/idno`

A3. Date and place of creation

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Date	When the document was written or produced	1906-06-10	`msDesc/history/origin/origDate (@when, or @notBefore and @notAfter)`
Source of the date	One of: on the document, postmark, inferred from content, other (say what)	on the document	`msDesc/history/origin/origDate/@evidence`
Place	Where the document was written or produced or “unknown”	Lifang (Tsingtao)	`msDesc/history/origin/origPlace`

A4. Physical description

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Extent	Number of leaves and written pages, e.g. "2 leaves, 3 pages written"	1 folded sheet, 4 pages written	`msDesc/physDesc/objectDesc/supportDesc/extent`

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Material and format	E.g. letter paper, postcard, printed brochure; give the size if unusual	squared paper	`msDesc/physDesc/objectDesc/supportDesc/support`
Original or copy	One of: original, carbon copy, photocopy, draft, transcript by someone else	original	`msDesc/physDesc/objectDesc/@form`
Writing	One of: handwritten, typewritten, printed, mixed	handwritten	`msDesc/physDesc/handDesc/handNote or msDesc/physDesc/typeDesc/typeNote`
Letterhead, stamps, seals	Short description		`msDesc/physDesc/additions`
Later additions	Handwritten notes, underlinings or marginalia added later, and by whom if known	Chinese numerals written in ink on pages 3 and 4	`msDesc/physDesc/additions; one handDesc/handNote per further hand`
Damage	Tears, fading, missing pages, loss of text	folds, slight staining	`msDesc/physDesc/objectDesc/supportDesc/condition`
Enclosures	Envelope, clippings, photographs. Say whether they are photographed here or as a separate document (give its ID)		`msDesc/physDesc/accMat`

A5. Content

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Language(s)	All languages used in the document	de; zh	`profileDesc/langUsage/language/@ident`
Summary	Two to four sentences: what is the document about?	Schlote thanks his fiancée for her letters, writes about growing potatoes in China, the German-style town of Tsingtao and the Chinese numerals he is learning to write.	`profileDesc/abstract`

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Keywords	Three to six topics, separated by semicolons	Kiautschou; Tsingtao; everyday life; Chinese script	`profileDesc/textClass/keywords/term`
Names mentioned	Persons, institutions and events an annotator should recognise	Lüdeke, Maria	`fileDesc/notesStmt/note[@type="entities"]`
Related documents	E.g. "reply to no. 0041", "draft of no. 0050"		`fileDesc/notesStmt/relatedItem` and `msDesc/additional/listBibl`

A6. Rights and sensitivity

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
May it be published?	Yes, no or unclear	yes	`fileDesc/publicationStmt/availability/@status`
Reason for any restriction	E.g. author still in copyright, living persons mentioned, private content, condition set by the archive		`fileDesc/publicationStmt/availability/p`
Rights holder	Heirs, archive or publisher, if known	public domain (CC0 1.0 for the scans)	`fileDesc/publicationStmt/availability/licence`

A7. Images and responsibility

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Image files	File names in reading order with the page or side, e.g. IMG_0231 = 1r	Seite_1 = 1r; Seite_2_und_3 = 1v-2r; Seite_4 = 2v	Outside the header: `facsimile/surface/graphic/@url`
Pages not photographed	Blank or missing pages, if any		`msDesc/physDesc/objectDesc/supportDesc/foliation`
Photographed by	Name and date	Schwabe, Bernd, 2026	`fileDesc/titleStmt/respStmt (resp: photography)`
Form filled in by	Name and date		`fileDesc/titleStmt/respStmt (resp: metadata)` and `revisionDesc/change`

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Other remarks	Anything else worth noting	Envelope (not included) postmarked Tsingtau 1906-09-19, arrival stamp Linden 1906-10-30.	`fileDesc/notesStmt/note`

B. Letters, postcards and telegrams only

In the TEI column, `correspDesc/` is short for `profileDesc/correspDesc/`.

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Sender(s)	Person or institution that sent the letter	Schlote, Ernst	`correspDesc/ correspAction[@type="sent"]/persName or orgName`
Place of sending	As given in the letter or on the postmark	Lifang (Tsingtao)	`correspDesc/ correspAction[@type="sent"]/placeName`
Date of sending	As given in the letter or on the postmark	1906-06-10	`correspDesc/ correspAction[@type="sent"]/date/@when`
Addressee(s)	Person or institution the letter is addressed to	Lüdeke, Maria	`correspDesc/ correspAction[@type="received"]/persName or orgName`
Place of receipt	Address the letter was sent to	Linden bei Hannover	`correspDesc/ correspAction[@type="received"]/placeName`
Date of receipt	Only if noted, e.g. by a receipt stamp	1906-10-30	`correspDesc/ correspAction[@type="received"]/date/@when`
Answers which letter?	ID or description of the earlier letter		`correspDesc/ correspContext/ ref[@type="replyTo"]`
Answered by which letter?	ID or description of the later letter		`correspDesc/ correspContext/ ref[@type="repliedBy"]`
Written on behalf of someone?	Name of the secretary or other person who wrote it, if not the sender		`correspDesc/ correspAction[@type="sent"]/ persName[@role="scribe"]`

C. Conference programs and other printed matter only

In the TEI column, `biblStruct/` is short for `fileDesc/sourceDesc/biblStruct/`.

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Name of the event	Conference, congress, workshop or lecture series		`biblStruct/monogr/ meeting`

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Date(s) of the event	First and last day		`biblStruct/monogr/meeting/date`
Place of the event	City and venue		`biblStruct/monogr/meeting/placeName`
Organiser(s)	Society, institute or persons		`biblStruct/monogr/respStmt (resp: organiser)`
Publisher or printer	Name and place, if printed		`biblStruct/monogr/imprint/publisher and pubPlace`
Role of the estate's creator	One of: speaker, chair, organiser, participant, unknown		`fileDesc/notesStmt/note[@type="participation"]`

D. Papers, talks and manuscripts only

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Stage of the text	One of: notes, draft, fair copy, version sent for publication, printed offprint		`msDesc/msContents/msItem/note[@type="stage"]`
Occasion	Conference, lecture series or journal it was written for		`profileDesc/creation`
Later published?	Full reference, if known		`msDesc/additional/listBibl/bibl`
Differs from the published version?	One of: unknown, minor differences, substantial differences		`msDesc/additional/listBibl/bibl/note`

Syfang, den 10. Juni 06.

Meine innigstgeliebte Maria!

Deinen lieben Briefe vom 27. IV und 4. V. habe ich gestern erhalten, und zu meiner Freude gelesen, dass du meine liebe Braut nebst guten Eltern noch gesund und wohl seid. Was meiner Gesundheit betrifft, so bin ich auch noch immer wohl und zufrieden. Über den Besuch bei meiner lieben Mutter habe ich mich sehr gefreut, und darf annehmen, dass es dir meine gute Braut nebst Mutter gut bekommen ist. dann frägst du liebe Maria über das Gedeihen der Kartoffeln solle ich berichten. Man kann die Kartoffeln hier in China sogar 2 mal ernten, es gibt aber deshalb keine weil die Chinesen keine pflanzen und auch diese ~~Preise~~ kosteten dieselben das Jahr 50 ₰ 3-4 M. man ist so mit gezwungen selbst welche zu pflanzen und kostet nur einige Dollar Kulilöhne. Die Gerste ist wie ich heute gesehen schon reif und wird vielfach schon abgeschnitten.

Auf diese Felder pflanzen dann die Chinesen ihre Chinesenkartoffeln welche bedeutend länger und größer sind wie die unsrigen. Dieselben schmecken natürlich süß und werden ~~bevor~~ sie gegessen an der Sonne getrocknet auch halten sie sich den Winter über besser, sonst würden sie auch wieder leicht faulen. Dann schreibst du liebe Maria die Häuser auf der Ansichtskarte wären nach deutschem Stil gebaut. Dann muß ich dir noch mitteilen daß Tsingtau eine vollständige deutsche Stadt wo fast* nur deutsche wohnen. Das Chinesenviertel ist ein Ort für sich und heißt Tabautau auch hier sind die Häuser schon nach deutscher Art gebaut und genau nach Polizeivorschrift bekanntlich wo die preußische Polizei ist da setzt es gleich hohe Strafen und die werden von den Chinesen sehr gefürchtet.

Nun will ich dir gute Maria einiges aus meinem Chinesischen mitteilen besonders über das Zahlen schreiben welche ich bereits alle kann dieselben sind alle mit einem Pinsel geschrieben. Auch muß man diese Zeichen von hinten lesen nämlich der Chinese liest ein Buch von hinten nach vorn wie die Juden.

壹 1
貳 2
叁 3
肆 4
伍 5
陸 6
柒 7
捌 8
玖 9
拾 10

千 1000
百 100
萬 10000
零 0

壹千玖百零陸 1906

壹千萬貳千叁百肆拾伍個 1002345

Diese Zahlen kann ich vollständig ohne eine Vorlage schreiben und habe es nicht gemacht wie andere Herren von einem Chinesen schreiben es ist sehr schwer dieselben zu behalten man muß täglich üben. Auch habe ich eine besondere Lust auch geht die Zeit damit sehr schön hin.

一 二 三 四 五 六 七 八 九 十

diese sind die einfachen Zahlen die sich leicht verändern lassen, welche man bei wichtigen Angelegenheiten nicht anwendet von 1–10 die schweren Zahlen werden immer wie die ersten geschrieben.

Nun will ich schließen mit vielen Grüßen an die lieben Eltern und besonders schönen Gruß und Kuß für dich meine traute Braut.

verbleibe ich
dein treuliebender
Fritz.